



Department of Economics
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November 24, 2025

Search Committee
Department of Economics
Tufts University
Medford, MA 02155
USA

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to apply for the tenure-track Assistant Professor position in the Department of Economics at Tufts University, beginning in September 2026. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, advised by Professors Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis, and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My research fields are macroeconomics, international macroeconomics, and heterogeneous-agent modeling, with a particular focus on how wealth inequality and cross-household return heterogeneity shape aggregate dynamics.

My job market paper estimates the distribution and persistence of household-level returns to wealth using Survey of Consumer Finances microdata and embeds those estimates into a heterogeneous-agent model to study how return dispersion amplifies wealth inequality. A second project uses Health and Retirement Study data to document a hump-shaped relationship between trust and realized portfolio returns, revealing a behavioral channel that affects macroeconomic wealth accumulation and differences in exposure to international risk. Together, these projects form a research agenda that links microeconomic frictions and heterogeneity to macroeconomic and international outcomes in a tractable and policy-relevant way.

Tufts' strengths in macroeconomics, international economics, and applied quantitative methods make it an ideal intellectual home for my work. I see strong complementarities with faculty studying international macro, open-economy frictions, and the distributional implications of global economic integration. I am enthusiastic about contributing to a department that values empirical grounding, rigorous modeling, and research with clear policy relevance.

Teaching. I have extensive experience leading weekly sections, holding office hours, and supporting students in *Introductory Macroeconomics*, *Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory*, and an upper-level *Macroeconomic Policy* seminar. I am prepared to teach *Macroeconomics*, *International Economics*, and *Graduate Macroeconomic Theory*, along with advanced undergraduate electives aligned with departmental needs. My instructional approach emphasizes clarity, structured problem-solving, and helping students build confidence through repeated engagement with dynamic models, data, and real-world applications. I also look forward to supervising undergraduate and graduate research that integrates empirical methods with modern macroeconomic modeling.

I believe I would be a strong fit for Tufts because my research addresses central questions in macroeconomics and international economics while maintaining a strong empirical foundation, and my teaching experience aligns directly with the department's needs in both its undergraduate

and graduate programs. I am excited about the opportunity to contribute to a vibrant academic community committed to high-quality research, excellent teaching, and engaged mentorship.

Thank you for your consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application and research with you.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards